Shapley Decomposition of Redistribution Outcomes

Candidates = every catalog row for that survey with `used == 1`, excluding the *policy* and *politics* groups. One page per outcome: the per-variable table lists individual items' Shapley (LMG) share of R^2; the per-cluster table sums those shares to the cluster level. Variables below 3% and clusters below 5% of R^2 are omitted (flagged inside each table); variables are shown by short question description only, without survey codes. ANES/GSS/WVS/Chinoy pool multiple survey years or waves with rotating item batteries, so those four use pairwise-complete correlations instead of a single complete-case sample (marked *pairwise-complete*); read their per-item numbers as suggestive, not exact.

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Govt should reduce income differences (GSS)

Full model $R^2 = 0.271$, $N = 1{,}849$ *(pairwise-complete correlations)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	inequality exists for benefit of rich	19.2%
2	conflict between poor and rich in usa?	9.2%
3	rich buy better health care than poor	6.2%
4	rich buy better education than poor	5.5%
5	inequality due to lack of solidarity	5.4%
6	r's self ranking of social position	5.1%
7	opinion of family income	4.5%
8	r's pay is just	3.3%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	wealth zero-sum	20.1%
2	class conflict	14.6%
3	wealth from advantages	12.4%
4	distributive principle / desert	11.0%
5	social class	7.8%
6	income	7.5%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

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6	income	7.5%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Govt should reduce income differentials (GSS)

Full model $R^2 = 0.308$, $N = 2{,}335$ *(pairwise-complete correlations)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	inequality exists for benefit of rich	21.7%
2	conflict between poor and rich in usa?	8.8%
3	inequality due to lack of solidarity	7.1%
4	rich buy better health care than poor	4.7%
5	rich buy better education than poor	4.0%
6	family income in constant dollars (REALINC, 1986 base)	3.6%
7	effort rewarded in america	3.4%
8	need to know right people to get ahead	3.3%
9	r's pay is just	3.3%
10	need wealthy family to get ahead	3.1%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	wealth zero-sum	23.5%
2	class conflict	15.9%
3	wealth from advantages	15.1%
4	distributive principle / desert	8.4%
5	income	7.9%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

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5	income	7.9%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Income equality (WVS (US))

Full model $R^2 = 0.180$, $N = 2{,}574$ *(pairwise-complete correlations)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	confidence in the government	16.9%
2	confidence in the environmental movement	15.4%
3	post-materialist values index (12-item)	15.1%
4	protecting environment vs. economic growth priority	9.0%
5	people who don't work turn lazy	6.0%
6	perceived impact of immigrants on the country's development	5.1%
7	frequency of attending religious services	4.9%
8	importance of religion in life	4.3%
9	household income decile (self-placed)	3.8%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	climate/environment concern	26.5%
2	government integrity	16.9%
3	materialism / ideal lifestyle	15.1%
4	religiosity	9.2%
5	deservingness of poor	6.0%
6	immigration	5.6%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

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	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Government responsibility (WVS (US))

Full model $R^2 = 0.299$, $N = 2{,}577$ *(pairwise-complete correlations)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	confidence in the government	18.9%
2	post-materialist values index (12-item)	14.9%
3	confidence in the environmental movement	12.2%
4	people who don't work turn lazy	7.1%
5	perceived impact of immigrants on the country's development	5.6%
6	protecting environment vs. economic growth priority	5.5%
7	satisfaction with household's financial situation	4.9%
8	household income decile (self-placed)	3.2%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	climate/environment concern	20.4%
2	government integrity	18.9%
3	materialism / ideal lifestyle	14.9%
4	deservingness of poor	7.1%
5	financial stress/risk	6.8%
6	immigration	6.6%
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Shapley R^2 decomposition

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	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Guaranteed jobs/income scale (ANES)

Full model $R^2 = 0.167$, $N = 2{,}164$ *(pairwise-complete correlations)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	Blacks have gotten less than they deserve	10.1%
2	gone too far pushing equal rights	9.7%
3	r's age	7.4%
4	r's family income, percentile group	7.3%
5	r's race/ethnicity, 7-category	6.9%
6	income kept up with cost of living last year	5.8%
7	federal spending to improve/protect the environment	5.6%
8	r financially better/worse off than a year ago	5.2%
9	worried about losing/finding a job	4.8%
10	r's family owns or rents home	4.6%
11	r's gender	4.2%
12	national unemployment gotten better/worse over past year	3.2%
13	how much the federal govt wastes tax money	3.0%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	income	13.3%
2	unemployment risk	10.2%
3	discrimination	10.1%
4	equality/dei zero-sum	9.7%
5	age	7.4%
6	race	6.9%
7	government integrity	5.9%
8	climate/environment concern	5.6%
9	financial stress/risk	5.2%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

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7	government integrity	5.9%
8	climate/environment concern	5.6%
9	financial stress/risk	5.2%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Federal spending on the poor (ANES)

Full model $R^2 = 0.208$, $N = 2{,}415$ *(pairwise-complete correlations)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	federal spending to improve/protect the environment	16.8%
2	Blacks have gotten less than they deserve	13.0%
3	r's education, 4-category	7.8%
4	gone too far pushing equal rights	7.2%
5	r's race/ethnicity, 7-category	6.1%
6	r devoted any time to volunteer work in last 12 months	5.8%
7	r's gender	4.6%
8	r's family income, percentile group	4.1%
9	most people can be trusted vs. can't be too careful	3.6%
10	r's social class, 8-category	3.5%
11	income kept up with cost of living last year	3.1%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	climate/environment concern	16.8%
2	discrimination	13.0%
3	education	7.8%
4	income	7.4%
5	equality/dei zero-sum	7.2%
6	social class	6.2%
7	race	6.1%
8	unemployment risk	5.9%
9	generosity	5.8%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

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	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

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6	social class	6.2%
7	race	6.1%
8	unemployment risk	5.9%
9	generosity	5.8%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Federal income tax should be more progressive (Own survey, 2025)

Full model $R^2 = 0.467$, $N = 1{,}052$ *(complete-case)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	higher taxes on high incomes make people work less	19.9%
2	people get rich at others' expense, not by creating value	14.4%
3	CEO pay gains came at expense of average workers	12.8%
4	DEI creates opportunity for some at others' expense	11.6%
5	large income gap needed to motivate entrepreneurs	9.1%
6	chance a hard-working poor child reaches richest 20%	4.4%
7	harder or easier to move up now vs. parents' day	4.3%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	wealth zero-sum	27.2%
2	individual incentives / tax elasticity	19.9%
3	equality/dei zero-sum	11.9%
4	perceived mobility / opportunity	10.8%
5	aggregate incentives / inequality positive-sum	9.1%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

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	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

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1	wealth zero-sum	27.2%
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5	aggregate incentives / inequality positive-sum	9.1%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Support for revenue-neutral tax-cut-for-low/rise-for-high proposal (Own survey, 2025)

Full model $R^2 = 0.325$, $N = 1{,}052$ *(complete-case)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	higher taxes on high incomes make people work less	29.4%
2	CEO pay gains came at expense of average workers	12.9%
3	people get rich at others' expense, not by creating value	10.6%
4	large income gap needed to motivate entrepreneurs	9.8%
5	DEI creates opportunity for some at others' expense	6.7%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	individual incentives / tax elasticity	29.4%
2	wealth zero-sum	23.5%
3	aggregate incentives / inequality positive-sum	9.8%
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By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
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2	wealth zero-sum	23.5%
3	aggregate incentives / inequality positive-sum	9.8%
4	equality/dei zero-sum	7.1%
5	perceived mobility / opportunity	6.8%
	— *clusters with <5% contribution omitted* —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Govt should concern itself with income differences (Own survey, 2025)

Full model $R^2 = 0.350$, $N = 1{,}052$ *(complete-case)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	people get rich at others' expense, not by creating value	15.7%
2	higher taxes on high incomes make people work less	12.6%
3	DEI creates opportunity for some at others' expense	11.3%
4	CEO pay gains came at expense of average workers	10.9%
5	large income gap needed to motivate entrepreneurs	7.9%
6	harder or easier to move up now vs. parents' day	4.3%
7	chance a hard-working poor child reaches richest 20%	3.6%
8	perceived risk of relocating due to climate events (10yr)	3.4%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	wealth zero-sum	26.6%
2	individual incentives / tax elasticity	12.6%
3	equality/dei zero-sum	11.6%
4	perceived mobility / opportunity	9.8%
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	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Govt should reduce income differences (Chinoy et al., 2020-23)

Full model $R^2 = 0.434$, $N = 8{,}095$ *(pairwise-complete correlations)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	how serious a problem racism in the US is	21.1%
2	generations of slavery make it hard for Blacks to leave lower class	16.7%
3	zero-sum between income classes	14.4%
4	how often women experience gender discrimination	9.3%
5	zero-sum between ethnic groups	6.4%
6	success in life is determined by forces outside our control	5.3%
7	incentivized zero-sum: if top 1% earn $100M more, what happens to bottom 50% income	4.4%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	discrimination	47.1%
2	wealth zero-sum	20.1%
3	perceived mobility / opportunity	8.2%
4	equality/dei zero-sum	8.2%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

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Full model $R^2 = 0.434$, $N = 8{,}095$ *(pairwise-complete correlations)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	how serious a problem racism in the US is	21.1%
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By cluster

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4	equality/dei zero-sum	8.2%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Whether upper-income people pay their fair share (Chinoy et al., 2020-23)

Full model $R^2 = 0.398$, $N = 8{,}076$ *(pairwise-complete correlations)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	zero-sum between income classes	11.3%
2	how serious a problem racism in the US is	11.2%
3	success in life is determined by forces outside our control	8.6%
4	generations of slavery make it hard for Blacks to leave lower class	7.9%
5	age in years	6.3%
6	everybody in the US has a chance to make it	5.7%
7	how often women experience gender discrimination	5.4%
8	incentivized zero-sum: if top 1% earn $100M more, what happens to bottom 50% income	4.4%
9	r's hard work has paid off	3.9%
10	importance of religion in life	3.4%
11	how often govt can be trusted to do what is right	3.0%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	discrimination	24.4%
2	perceived mobility / opportunity	16.6%
3	wealth zero-sum	16.5%
4	family income / background	9.6%
5	age	6.3%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

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Shapley R^2 decomposition

Govt should be responsible for reducing income differences (Stantcheva, 2019)

Full model $R^2 = 0.204$, $N = 2{,}712$ *(complete-case)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	high incomes are entitled to keep their income	26.5%
2	raising income tax on high earners would hurt/help the economy	17.2%
3	why a person is rich: effort vs. advantages	9.7%
4	middle class mostly wins if overall taxes are increased	5.2%
5	age in years	4.6%
6	working class mostly wins if overall taxes are increased	4.5%
7	upper-middle class mostly wins if overall taxes are increased	4.5%
8	Laffer effect: tax cuts on high-income households and the deficit	3.4%
9	lower class or poor mostly wins if taxes on high earners are cut	3.0%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	distributive principle / desert	26.5%
2	policy incidence	24.3%
3	aggregate incentives / inequality positive-sum	21.4%
4	wealth from effort/merit	9.7%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

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6	working class mostly wins if overall taxes are increased	4.5%
7	upper-middle class mostly wins if overall taxes are increased	4.5%
8	Laffer effect: tax cuts on high-income households and the deficit	3.4%
9	lower class or poor mostly wins if taxes on high earners are cut	3.0%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	distributive principle / desert	26.5%
2	policy incidence	24.3%
3	aggregate incentives / inequality positive-sum	21.4%
4	wealth from effort/merit	9.7%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Support raising taxes on high incomes to expand low-income programs (Stantcheva, 2019)

Full model $R^2 = 0.315$, $N = 2{,}713$ *(complete-case)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	high incomes are entitled to keep their income	31.9%
2	raising income tax on high earners would hurt/help the economy	10.5%
3	middle class mostly wins if overall taxes are increased	9.1%
4	why a person is rich: effort vs. advantages	8.2%
5	working class mostly wins if overall taxes are increased	6.1%
6	upper-middle class mostly wins if overall taxes are increased	3.9%
7	Laffer effect: tax cuts on high-income households and the deficit	3.4%
8	lower class or poor mostly wins if taxes on high earners are cut	3.3%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	distributive principle / desert	31.9%
2	policy incidence	31.3%
3	aggregate incentives / inequality positive-sum	14.1%
4	wealth from effort/merit	8.2%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Support raising taxes on high incomes to expand low-income programs (Stantcheva, 2019)

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Shapley R^2 decomposition

Preferred tax rate on the bottom 50% (Alesina et al., 2016)

Full model $R^2 = 0.099$, $N = 1{,}559$ *(complete-case)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	perceived chance a poor child reaches top quintile	23.9%
2	perceived chance a hard-working poor child reaches top quintile	12.4%
3	perceived chance a poor child reaches 4th quintile	10.8%
4	age in years	8.9%
5	perceived chance a hard-working poor child reaches 4th quintile	6.5%
6	own job prestige vs. father's	6.1%
7	everybody in the US has a chance to make it	5.5%
8	whether govt has ability/tools to reduce unequal opportunity	4.5%
9	why a person is rich: harder work vs. more advantages	4.5%
10	childhood family income vs. others	3.2%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	perceived mobility / opportunity	59.2%
2	family income / background	11.8%
3	age	8.9%
4	government integrity	5.8%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Preferred tax rate on the bottom 50% (Alesina et al., 2016)

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3	perceived chance a poor child reaches 4th quintile	10.8%
4	age in years	8.9%
5	perceived chance a hard-working poor child reaches 4th quintile	6.5%
6	own job prestige vs. father's	6.1%
7	everybody in the US has a chance to make it	5.5%
8	whether govt has ability/tools to reduce unequal opportunity	4.5%
9	why a person is rich: harder work vs. more advantages	4.5%
10	childhood family income vs. others	3.2%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	perceived mobility / opportunity	59.2%
2	family income / background	11.8%
3	age	8.9%
4	government integrity	5.8%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Preferred tax rate on the top 1% (Alesina et al., 2016)

Full model $R^2 = 0.113$, $N = 1{,}559$ *(complete-case)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	everybody in the US has a chance to make it	14.0%
2	why a person is rich: harder work vs. more advantages	11.5%
3	why a person is poor: lack of effort vs. circumstances	11.3%
4	perceived chance a poor child reaches 4th quintile	9.5%
5	age in years	9.2%
6	whether govt has ability/tools to reduce unequal opportunity	9.1%
7	perceived chance a poor child reaches top quintile	8.0%
8	perceived chance a hard-working poor child reaches 4th quintile	5.9%
9	perceived chance a hard-working poor child reaches top quintile	4.1%
10	own job prestige vs. father's	3.5%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

#	Cluster	% R^2
1	perceived mobility / opportunity	41.4%
2	wealth from effort/merit	11.5%
3	deservingness of poor	11.3%
4	government integrity	9.7%
5	family income / background	9.3%
6	age	9.2%
	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	

Shapley R^2 decomposition

Preferred tax rate on the top 1% (Alesina et al., 2016)

Full model $R^2 = 0.113$, $N = 1{,}559$ *(complete-case)*

By variable

#	Variable	% R^2
1	everybody in the US has a chance to make it	14.0%
2	why a person is rich: harder work vs. more advantages	11.5%
3	why a person is poor: lack of effort vs. circumstances	11.3%
4	perceived chance a poor child reaches 4th quintile	9.5%
5	age in years	9.2%
6	whether govt has ability/tools to reduce unequal opportunity	9.1%
7	perceived chance a poor child reaches top quintile	8.0%
8	perceived chance a hard-working poor child reaches 4th quintile	5.9%
9	perceived chance a hard-working poor child reaches top quintile	4.1%
10	own job prestige vs. father's	3.5%
	— variables with <3% contribution omitted —	

By cluster

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	— clusters with <5% contribution omitted —	